

financing model for empowering local Indian consumer brands, Klub is filling the void left by traditional models. In doing so, it is also solving for the Covid-19-triggered slowdown in demand that is impacting product innovation and growth. Multiple online-first brands have already recovered to pre-Covid levels, while offline brands are transitioning to online to target customers, triggered by the change in consumption trends. Klub is uniquely positioned to provide financial support to such D2C brands. Klub has already invested in nearly 25 loved local brands and aims to work with over 350 brands in 2021 alone."

Jain further added, "While fintech companies have been organically growing in India ever since demonetisation, COVID-19 expedited adoption by a number of years. As a hybrid marketplace providing flexible financing to D2C brands through Revenue Based Financing, Klub believes that there will be a consumption resurgence towards local brands that establish brand affinity and engage their loyal community. We believe that flexible financing solutions for SMEs and alternative investment products for investors will do well in 2021, along-with underlying platforms powering the digital transformation of the fintech ecosystem. Also, Indian fintech start-ups raised \$1.7 billion in funding in the first six months of 2020, doubling from last year's \$726.6 million, indicative of an upward trend in the coming years. Neobanking, UPI, and other digital financial services saw a boom, not just in the tier I cities, but also amongst the underserved sections of the population. With increasing adopters of digital payments on the demand and supply side, we see an upcoming shift of major businesses to the e-commerce model in the year 2021."

Mr Ashneer Grover, Co-Founder and CEO of BharatPe also anticipates an increase in volume of digital transactions in the coming months, "I believe that 2021 will see a further acceleration in the adoption of digital payments in India. UPI and

WhatsApp Pay will continue to be the driver. Also, I believe that next year we will see tier-2,3 and 4 cities as the key growth drivers for UPI and digital payments in the country. We have set ourselves a target of 5x growth and aiming for US\$30B TPV by March 2023."



An Indian customer executes a contactless payment at a kiosk for fast food in a store

08 DIGITAL COACHING

Edutech and upskilling platforms grew by leaps and bounds during the lockdown, with many mankind resources available for free particularly to school children who found their academic year severely disrupted. This led to a rapid digitisation of classrooms, and severe headaches for school teachers who had to deal with everything from parents helping prompting answers to their children during tests to randos from the internet zoom-bombing the lectures.

As the schools reopen and the students start to open up, one of the industries that is expected to see rapid growth are after-school coaching services that offer classes from the home. In particular, these classes focus on achieving results for specific exams and entrance tests.

Zishaan Hayath, CEO and Founder of Toppr explains, "This year has not only changed education as we know it, but it has also coerced all stakeholders of education to find better learning solutions. The changes edtech has brought will continue to influence classroom teaching even after schools reopen. As a result, more schools will

be using technology in their day-to-day classes. After-school market: coaching and tuitions, will be completely reimaged. Since students are now more open to learning online, edtech players will now have a bigger share of that pie and will start to consolidate. Currently, India has about 70 million students who are paying for after-school learning. We predict, over the next 2-3 years, ~20 million paying subscribers from this segment will migrate to digital learning."

Abhishek Patil - Co-Founder and CEO of Oliveboard also anticipates an increase in users opting for digital learning platforms in the near future. "In 2020, the ed-tech industry attracted students from schools, universities, businesses and individuals as classroom training was at a standstill due to the virus outbreak. At Oliveboard we saw a steady increase in online test preparation registrations as well. In addition, with both government and banking examinations in the pipeline, the online test preparation industry is about to experience its busiest season in the coming months."

Delivering training through the medium of computers means that they can be more boring lectures, with multimedia as well as data technologies used to the fullest, to deliver the learning in a manner that is most palatable, and do we dare say exciting, to the students. Patil goes on to explain, "learning Analytics and Gamification will play inevitable roles in the online test preparation industry, as it will allow educators to assess and report student learning only on the web and will further assist them to better understand and optimise learning. For example, teachers will be able to see what kind of knowledge students most enjoy and use it accordingly (text, photos, infographics, or videos). They will be able to note which portions have not been delivered successfully and strengthen them next time. Besides, learning analytics can also help educators classify learners who may have academic or behavioural problems. Teachers could then build a way to help students achieve their full potential."